MATTHEW COLE

Bradford, ON | 905-726-0167 | matthewisacole@gmail.com |

Career Objective – I am a third-year Specialized Honors BA of History student with a passion for curatorial and archival work. My goal is to pursue a career in archival studies, record management, library management or museum curation.

HIGHLIGHTS OF QUALIFICATIONS

- **Archival Studies:** Experience handling, digitizing, organizing and managing historical documents and artifacts.
- **Technical Skills:** Microsoft Office (Word, PowerPoint, Excel), Adobe Acrobat and Photoshop. Experience using a Microfilm Reader. File management. Knowledge of Zotero and OMNI.
- **Key Strengths:** Organized, detail oriented, punctual, fast learner, strong written and verbal communication skills, interpersonal skills, a self-starter and a team-player. Experience working with volunteers and event planning. Plenty of experience in customer service roles, and conflict resolution.
- **Other useful qualifications:** Class "G" driver's license (2021)/Ability to lift heavy objects if needed.
- **Emergency First Aid – CPR/AED Level C:** April 5th, 2024 (Certificate no. 104938438)

EDUCATION

Toronto Metropolitan University, Toronto, ON - Part-time Spring/Summer Courses – Continuing Education **January 2023 – July 2023**

Key Courses: Intro to World and Early European Music, History of the Caribbean

York University, North York, ON - Student (Third Year) – Specialized Honors BA of History **September 2023 – Present**

Key Courses: HIST2500 Canadian History, HIST3460 The Shaping of Modern Ireland, HIST1040 Popular Uses of History (An Introduction to Public History), ITEC-1000 Introduction to Information Technology, HIST3355 Modern Greece, ADMS2200 Introductory Marketing

WORK EXPERIENCE

Archives Support Assistant (and Summer Archives Assistant) **May 2025 – Current**

York University Libraries (Clara Thomas Archives and Special Collections), North York, ON

- Monitoring the archive's reading room and classroom. Assisting researchers with accessing our collections, as well as answering any questions members of the public have regarding our archive and its holdings. Making sure students attending classes in our classroom follow the archive's rules. Listing new donations using Zotero, shelf-reading and rehousing collections. Re-sleeving photographs, completing scanning/digitization orders and updating finding-aids for collections. Pulling and re-shelving material from our holdings. Experience with handling restricted/confidential material.

Library Assistant **May 2024 – April 2025**

York University Libraries, North York, ON

- Assisting with circulation tasks such as managing book loans and returns, answering patrons' questions via phone or in-person, and helping patrons search for items on the library's catalogue system. Performing various tasks in the library stacks such as reshelving books, picking book orders for hold or transfer, performing missing items searches, shelf reading, tidying up the shelves and monitoring the library's study spaces.

Information Officer and Registration Officer **April 28th, 2024 (Election Day)**

BWG Leisure Centre (Elections Canada Polling Station), Bradford, ON

- Worked at my local polling station during the 2024 Canadian Federal Election. My responsibilities included welcoming and directing voters to the correct locations, checking if they brought the correct identification to vote, and registering first-time voters. My conflict-resolution skills were needed a few times.

Summer Museum Attendant **May 2024 – August 2024**

Georgina Pioneer Village and Archives, Town of Georgina, ON

- Researching and creating new exhibits and activities for the museum. Orchestrating various research projects regarding the history of the region and the genealogy of local families and individuals. Assisting with the daily operation of the village, performing general maintenance on the historic buildings and their displays. Providing tours for visitors and answering any questions about the village and its history. Assisting with planning and running special events.

PERSONAL PROJECTS AND HOBBIES

Personal Genealogical Research **February 2020 – Present**

- **Began genealogical research** for my family tree at beginning of the COVID-19 pandemic, thus added to my knowledge & research skills. I am now conducting research for others.
- **Well-acquainted with the genealogical resources available to:** Ontario, Quebec, Nova Scotia, Newfoundland, Northeastern United States, Jamaica, Scotland, England, Ireland, and Germany.
- **Experience using genealogy websites such as:** Ancestry.ca, Familysearch.org, FindMyPast.co.uk, scotlandspeople.co.uk, banq.qc.ca, ngb.chebucto.org, collections.mun.ca, nationalarchives.gov.uk, archives.novascotia.ca, jamaicanfamilysearch.com, newspapers.com, bac-lac.gc.ca, among many others.
- **Digitizing and managing family documents:** Including photographs, marriage documents, war documents, letters, research notes from relatives, 8mm and super8mm film, diaries, etc.

Antique Collecting and Restoration **2016 – Present**

- Avid antique collector including but not limited to typewriters, clocks, musical instruments, uranium glass, maps/globes, paper documents and books, paintings, WWI and WWII memorabilia. I have restored several of these antiques to like-new condition, with my favourite restoration job being my 1880 reed organ.

Music

- A proficient organ and piano musician, performing for church events and family gatherings.

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENT

Recipient of the York University Continuing Student Scholarship **Awarded in August 2025**

- Earned through demonstrating "outstanding academic results" in the fall/winter 2024-25 academic sessions.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE AND MEMBERSHIPS

Summer Camp Volunteer at Grace Church, Newmarket, Ontario **2014 – 2019**

- Responsible for event setup, arts/crafts, snacks, games, among other event prep tasks.

LA&PS Dean's Circle of Student Scholars 2025-2026 (York University) **2025 – present**

- Membership to York University's LA&PS Dean's Circle of Student Scholars is earned through maintaining a cumulative GPA greater than 8 (out of 9)

Member of the Georgina Historical Society **July 2024 – present**

- Follow the newsletter and local happenings. Attend society meetings. Contribute to campaigns/efforts to preserve The Town of Georgina's local heritage.